



▲ TAAL, WITH TAAL LAKE IN THE CALDERA

Tambora

Location On the island of Sumbawa, Indonesia

Tambora’s eruption in 1815 was the biggest in recorded history—it killed about 12,000 people. Huge clouds of ash and pumice were emitted into the atmosphere and dimmed sunlight, lowering global temperatures and creating the “year without a summer” in 1816. Tambora lost 4,900 ft (1,500 m) of its height in the eruption, and the present giant caldera formed, 4 miles (6 km) across and 3,640 ft (1,110 m) deep. At sea level, Tambora is 40 miles (60 km) in diameter.

Kelimutu

Location On the island of Flores, Indonesia

This complex volcano has three crater lakes, whose waters are different colors despite being at the summit of the same volcano. Different oxides and salts give the lakes their varying colors. Tiwu Ata Mbupu is usually blue, while Tiwu Ata Polo and Tiwu Nua Muri Kooh Tai, which share the same crater wall, are typically red and green, respectively. The lakes, which are fed by underwater fumaroles, periodically change color.

Taal Volcano

Location In the west of the island of Luzon, the Philippines

The Philippines’ second most active volcano after Mayon (see p.355), Taal is known to have erupted 33 times since 1572, with particularly large events in 1754 and 1911. Recent eruptions have been concentrated on Volcano Island, which is in the middle of Taal Lake. The lake fills much of a massive, ancient caldera. Taal is one of a chain of volcanoes that were formed by the subduction of the Eurasian Plate under the Philippines.

Lake Toba

Location In the north of Sumatra, Indonesia

The largest volcanic lake in the world, this was the site of the biggest known eruption of the last 25 million years. The blast, which occurred about 75,000 years ago, covered parts of Sumatra beneath 2,000 ft (600 m) of ash. The collapse of the volcano after the eruption formed a huge caldera, which subsequently filled with water. The lake is now 60 miles (100 km) by 20 miles (30 km) and plunges to 1,657 ft (505 m) deep.

Mount Merapi

Location On the island of Java, Indonesia

This stratovolcano is the most energetic of Indonesia’s 129 active volcanoes, and forms part of the Pacific Ring of Fire. It has erupted regularly in the last 500 years, causing many fatalities. Merapi rises 9,738 ft (2,968 m), somewhat lower than before its 2010 eruption, which killed more than 300 people living on its slopes. The volcano is situated over a subduction zone where the Indo-Australian Plate is pushing under the Sunda Plate.

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